

Every date that matters — Fall 2027 entry

All deadlines for the twelve universities under consideration, consolidated from the program dossiers (researched against official sources Aug 15, 2026). Dates are the published cycle's — re-verify each when applications open in fall 2026.

Oct 15

earliest hard date (Stanford REA + arts portfolio)

Nov 1-2

nine early deadlines land together

Dec 1

NEC dual-degree + CMU Music (both with violin prescreen)

May 1

Decision Day — one choice

1 The shape of the year

Five seasons, in order. The heavy lifting is September–December; spring is auditions and decisions.

Aug – Sep 2026 UW & UIUC apps open · UC app drafting · optional SAT EBRW retake (Aug/Sep sittings) · essays	Oct – Nov Stanford arts REA Oct 15 · UC files Oct 1–Nov 30 · Nov 1-2 early wave · UW Nov 15 · UC Nov 30	Dec Dec 1: NEC + CMU Music prescreens · early decisions mid-Dec · RD essays finalized	Jan – Feb RD wave Jan 1–5 · NEC recs Jan 15 · Feb: NEC live audition (Boston) · aid forms	Mar – May Decisions Feb–Apr · aid offers · May 1: commit
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2 What's in focus — the mental picture, month by month

Each month has one job. Gold ★ rows are Eidee's personal milestones; the rest are external deadlines. (Items marked "TBD/confirm" need a date or a decision from the family — they can be updated through the admission-book skill.)

August 2026

FOUNDATION — SET THE BOARD

- › **UW application opens Aug 15** — the safety goes first; draft its essays now
- ★ **SAT plan locked:** register for the fall sittings needed for the EBRW retake (target 750+)
- ★ **Audition repertoire in daily rotation:** Bach Partita No. 3 (Preludio + Gavotte en Rondeau), Prokofiev concerto mvt, Paganini caprice, Wieniawski / Sarasate *Zigeunerweisen*
- ★ **ED/REA deliberation opens:** gather the one-early-card facts (see planning notes)

September 2026

OPENINGS — DECIDE AND DRAFT

- › **UIUC opens Sep 1** (CS + Philosophy must be first-choice major)
- ★ **TARA test** — date TBD (family to confirm and pin)
- ★ **SAT sitting (if taken)** — safest last chance for the early round; check College Board registration deadlines
- ★ **ED/REA choice made by Sep 30** — it dictates October's workload
- ★ **Audition recording session 1** — first full takes of all four works
- › Common App + UC PIQ essay drafts complete

October 2026

COMMIT MONTH — RECORD AND FILE EARLY

- › **Oct 1:** UC filing window opens · CSS Profile & FAFSA open
- › **Oct 15 / Oct 20:** Stanford REA *with arts portfolio* — only if Stanford is the early card
- ★ **Last SAT chance for REA/SCEA schools — the October sitting** (Harvard accepts early-Nov; MIT EA through Nov 30)
- ★ **Audition recording FINAL takes** — the master video set must exist by Oct 31; it feeds every portfolio and both Dec 1 prescreens
- › Teacher/counselor recommendations confirmed in the portals

November 2026

THE WAVE — SUBMIT EVERYTHING EARLY

- › **Nov 1-2:** the early application (chosen card) + UIUC EA + any non-restricted publics
- › **Nov 6 / Nov 8:** Princeton / Yale early arts supplements (from the master video)
- › **Nov 15:** UW deadline · early aid forms (Stanford/UChicago/Cornell/CMU)
- › **Nov 30:** UC application closes · MIT EA last test date + aid forms
- ★ **RD essays drafted before Thanksgiving** — December belongs to music

December 2026

MUSIC MONTH — AND EVERYTHING FINISHED

- › **Dec 1:** NEC prescreen + CMU Music application/prescreen — both from the October master video
- › **Dec 5 / Dec 10:** Stanford RD *with arts portfolio* — the early-RD music track
- ★ **December SAT** — final chance that reaches RD readers (and MIT RA, scores by Feb 15)
- › **Mid-Dec:** early decision arrives — defer/deny means the RD wave goes out as planned
- ★ **Dec 31 house rule: every remaining application submitted** — nothing left for January deadlines

January 2027

FOLLOW-THROUGH — SUPPLEMENTS AND RECS

- › **Jan 1-5:** RD deadlines pass (already submitted per the Dec 31 rule)
- › **Jan 8 / Jan 9:** Princeton / Yale RD arts supplements
- › **Jan 15:** NEC recommendations & transcripts · UChicago ED II aid
- › **Jan 10:** Berkeley invited letters (if invited)
- ★ **February audition prep begins:** NEC live adds étude/caprice + piano sonata (or Mozart) + the personally meaningful piece

February

- ★ **NEC live audition, Boston**
- ★ **CMU live audition** (Pittsburgh/NYC)
- › RD aid forms (Feb 1 / Feb 15)

March

- › UW decisions Mar 1-15
- › Late-March decision wave + NEC
- › Berkeley aid due Mar 2

April

- › Stanford / Penn / CMU decisions
- ★ **Compare aid offers; visit if possible**

May 2027

- › **May 1: Decision Day** — one deposit
- ★ **AP exams:** Calc BC · Physics 1 · CS A · English Lit · Statistics/Psychology

Eidee's recording repertoire → what each piece unlocks. The four works cover nearly every requirement:

Work	Satisfies
Bach Partita No. 3 in E major — Preludio + Gavotte en Rondeau	NEC prescreen's <i>two contrasting Bach movements</i> ✓ · CMU's Bach movement ✓ · Bach anchor for Stanford/Princeton/MIT/Yale/Cornell portfolios ✓
Prokofiev Violin Concerto (1st mvt / exposition)	NEC's major concerto 1800-1945 ✓ · CMU's non-Baroque concerto Allegro ✓ · the "big" portfolio piece ✓
Paganini Caprice (<i>listed as "No. 25" — the 24 Caprices end at No. 24; confirm which is meant, e.g. No. 24</i>)	CMU's étude/caprice (memorized) ✓ · NEC <i>live-audition</i> étude slot (Paganini Op. 1 qualifies) ✓
Wieniawski / Sarasate Zigeunerweisen	NEC's "personally meaningful piece" ✓ · the short contrasting showpiece for the ~10-min portfolios ✓

Still uncovered for NEC's live audition only: the piano-accompanied sonata movement (or Mozart concerto exposition if unaccompanied) — prepare over winter break.

3 Month-by-month master checklist

Every dated obligation, in the order it arrives. Music-related items are shaded gold. Color bar = school (named on every line).

September 2026		October 2026		November 2026	
Sep 1	UIUC application opens	Oct 1	UC Berkeley filing window opens (through Nov 30)	Nov 1	Harvard REA + aid forms (CSS/FAFSA/IDOC)
Sep (mid)	All schools — confirm 2026–27 dates as sites update	Oct 1	Aid — CSS Profile & FAFSA open	Nov 1	Yale SCEA
Sep	Violin — record prescreen/arts-supplement footage early MUSIC	Oct 15	Stanford REA with arts portfolio: application due MUSIC	Nov 1	Princeton SCEA
		Oct 20	Stanford REA portfolio materials due MUSIC	Nov 1	Stanford REA (no-portfolio track)
		Oct 31	Stanford REA: last SAT sitting (ACT: end of Sep)	Nov 1	MIT EA (own portal)
				Nov 1	UPenn ED (binding)
				Nov 1	Cornell ED (binding; materials Nov 13)
				Nov 1	UIUC Early Action (materials Nov 7)
				Nov 2	UChicago EA / ED I
				Nov 6	Princeton SCEA arts supplement MUSIC
				Nov 8	Yale SCEA music supplement MUSIC
				Nov 15	UW single application deadline
				Nov 15	Aid — Stanford REA · UChicago EA/ED I · CMU ED · Cornell ED forms
				Nov 30	UC Berkeley application closes
				Nov 30	MIT EA: last SAT/ACT date · aid forms due

December 2026	January 2027	February 2027
Dec 1 Harvard-NEC dual degree: NEC application + prescreen video MUSIC	Jan 1 Harvard RD	Feb 1 Aid — Harvard & UPenn RD forms · UW priority date
Dec 1 CMU School of Music application + violin prescreen (Accepted); no ED for Music MUSIC	Jan 1 Princeton RD	Feb NEC live audition, Boston (prescreen passers; higher-than-B.M. standard) MUSIC
Dec 5 Stanford RD with arts portfolio: application due (materials Dec 10) MUSIC	Jan 2 Yale RD	Feb CMU Music live audition (dates TBA; Pittsburgh + NYC regionals) MUSIC
Mid-Dec Early decisions — Harvard, Yale, Princeton, Stanford, MIT, UPenn, Cornell, UChicago	Jan 4 MIT Regular Action	Feb 15 Aid — Stanford, MIT, CMU, Cornell, UChicago RD forms · NEC aid priority
Dec 31 MIT RA: last SAT/ACT date (scores by Feb 15)	Jan 4 UChicago ED II / RD	Mid-Feb UChicago ED II decisions
	Jan 5 CMU RD (non-Music colleges)	Feb 28 UW Husky Promise FAFSA/WASFA date (WA residents)
	Jan 5 Stanford RD	
	Jan 5 UPenn RD	
	Jan 5 UIUC regular deadline (materials Jan 11)	
	Jan 8 Princeton RD arts supplement MUSIC	
	Jan 9 Yale RD music supplement MUSIC	
	Jan 10 UC Berkeley optional invited letters due	
	Jan 15 NEC recommendations & transcripts MUSIC	
	Jan 15 UChicago ED II aid forms	
	~Jan 30 UIUC EA decisions (CS+X may defer to March)	
March 2027	April 2027	May 2027
Mar 1–15 UW decisions	Early Apr Stanford RD decisions	May 1 National Decision Day — deposit at ONE school (UC SIR also due May 1)
Mar 2 UC Berkeley FAFSA/CADAA deadline	Apr UPenn RD decisions	
~Mar 6 UIUC regular decisions	By Apr 1 CMU decisions (incl. School of Music)	
Mid-Mar MIT RA decisions	Apr Compare aid offers — appeal windows are short	
Late Mar RD decisions — Harvard, Yale, Princeton, Cornell, UChicago, Berkeley		
Late Mar NEC dual-degree decision MUSIC		
~Mar 15 UIUC FAFSA priority date		

4 School-by-school card file

The same dates, filed per school — for pinning next to each application.

Stanford

COMMON APP • \$100 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

REA (arts track)

Oct 15 / Oct 20

REA standard

Nov 1

RD (arts track)

Dec 5 / Dec 10

RD standard

Jan 5

Aid (REA / RD)

Nov 15 / Feb 15

Decisions

mid-Dec / early Apr

Princeton

COMMON APP • TEST-OPTIONAL (FINAL YEAR)

SCEA

Nov 1

Arts supp (SCEA/RD)

Nov 6 / Jan 8

RD

Jan 1

Decisions

mid-Dec / late Mar

Harvard (+ NEC)

COMMON APP • \$90 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

REA + aid forms

Nov 1

NEC app + prescreen

Dec 1

RD

Jan 1

NEC recs

Jan 15

NEC live audition

February

Decisions (both)

mid-Dec / late Mar

Yale

COMMON APP • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

SCEA

Nov 1

Music supp (SCEA/RD)

Nov 8 / Jan 9

RD

Jan 2

Decisions

mid-Dec / late Mar

B.A./M.M. audition

pre-matriculation or 3rd year — not this cycle

MIT

MIT PORTAL • \$75 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

EA

Nov 1

Last test (EA / RA)

Nov 30 / Dec 31

Aid (EA / RA)

Nov 30 / Feb 15

RA

Jan 4

Decisions

mid-Dec / mid-Mar

UChicago

COMMON APP • TEST-OPTIONAL • NO CSS

EA / ED I

Nov 2

ED II / RD

Jan 4

Aid (EA / EDII / RD)

Nov 15 / Jan 15 / Feb 15

Decisions

mid-Dec / mid-Feb / late Mar

CMU

COMMON APP • \$75 • CFA TEST-OPTIONAL

Music app + prescreen

Dec 1

ED (non-Music)

Nov 2

RD (non-Music)

Jan 4

Live audition

Feb (TBA)

Decisions

by Apr 1

UPenn

COMMON APP • \$75 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

ED (binding)

Nov 1

Last SAT (ED / RD)

Nov 7 / Dec 5

Aid (ED / RD)

Nov 6 / Feb 1

RD

Jan 5

Decisions

Dec / Apr

Cornell

COMMON APP • \$85 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

ED (binding)

Nov 1 (materials Nov 13)

RD

Jan 2 (materials Jan 19)

Aid (ED / RD)

~Nov 15 / ~Feb 15

Decisions

mid-Dec / late Mar

UC Berkeley

UC APP ONLY • \$80 • TEST-BLIND

Filing window

Oct 1 - Nov 30

Invited letters

Jan 10

Aid (FAFSA/CADAA)

Mar 2

Decisions / SIR

end Mar / May 1

UIUC

MYILLINOIS OR COMMON APP • TEST-OPTIONAL

App opens

Sep 1

EA

Nov 1 (materials Nov 7)

Regular

Jan 5 (materials Jan 11)

Decisions (EA / RD)

~Jan 30 / ~Mar 6

FAFSA priority

~Mar 15

UW–Seattle

COMMON APP • \$85 • TEST-FREE

Opens / closes

Aug 15 / Nov 15

Aid priority

Feb 1 (Husky Promise Feb 28)

Decisions

Mar 1–15

Music

no audition at admission; ensembles audition Sep after enrolling

5 Violin — portfolio & audition repertoire, stage by stage

Every program that can receive Eidee's playing, what each stage requires, and when it's due. Verified against the official audition/portfolio pages Aug 15, 2026.

NEC — Harvard dual degree

REQUIRED • JUDGED ABOVE B.M. STANDARD •
NECMUSIC.EDU/AUDITIONS/VIOLIN

Prescreen video
due Dec 1

① Exposition (or first 5 min) of the 1st mvt of a **major concerto, 1800–1945** (Shostakovich No. 1: 4th mvt/cadenza allowed) • ② **Two contrasting movements** of an unaccompanied **Bach** sonata/partita. Single unedited takes, one file per piece.

Live audition
February, Boston (memorized)

① Concerto 1st mvt (1800–1945) • ② two contrasting Bach mvts (may reuse prescreen) • ③ **étude/caprice** from Rode Op. 22, Dont Op. 35, Wieniawski Op. 10/18, or Paganini Op. 1 • ④ sonata 1st mvt with piano in a contrasting style — or Mozart concerto exposition (Mozart *required* if unaccompanied) • ⑤ **one personally meaningful piece** of her choosing.

Recorded alternative

15-minute **single continuous unedited take**, memorized; ≥3 selections incl. concerto exposition + one Bach mvt + own choice.

CMU School of Music (BXA)

REQUIRED • ALL REPERTOIRE FROM MEMORY • VIA ACCEPTD

Prescreen video
due Dec 1

① One **étude** (Kreutzer, Fiorillo, Rode, Dont, Gaviniès) or a **caprice** (Wieniawski, Paganini) • ② **Allegro movement of a non-Baroque concerto** • ③ one movement of a **Bach solo sonata/partita**.

Live audition
Feb (TBA); Pittsburgh or NYC

Same repertoire as the prescreen; **unaccompanied**.

Stanford — Arts Portfolio (Music)

OPTIONAL • VIDEO ONLY • MOVES THE WHOLE APP EARLIER

Due (REA)

app Oct 15 • media Oct 20

Due (RD)

app Dec 5 • media Dec 10

Content

2–3 short contrasting pieces, ~10 min total; videos no older than one year; accompaniment optional (no disadvantage without). Music résumé; a teacher recommendation encouraged.

Princeton — Arts Supplement (Music)

OPTIONAL • REVIEWED BY MUSIC FACULTY

Due (SCEA / RD)

Nov 6 / Jan 8

Content

10–15 min of advanced solo work showing **contrasting expression and technique** (no ensemble unless prominently soloed). Audio or video (or YouTube/Vimeo/SoundCloud). Plus music résumé and a **250-word statement** on integrating music at Princeton.

MIT — Creative Portfolio (Music)

OPTIONAL · SLIDEROOM · \$10 (WAIVABLE ≥3 DAYS PRE-DEADLINE)

Due	with the application (Nov 1 EA / Jan 4 RA)
Content	Two recordings of contrasting styles/periods, 10 min combined; unedited solo performances, accompaniment as feasible. Performing-arts résumé + one music-teacher recommendation requested through SlideRoom. Reviewed by Music & Theater Arts faculty.

Yale — Music Supplement · Cornell — Recording

OPTIONAL AT BOTH · NO FIXED REPERTOIRE PUBLISHED

Yale (SCEA / RD)	Nov 8 / Jan 9 via the status portal; audio or video. Yale's own advice: submit only if it shows "a high level of ability" ; consult the Music Dept guidelines for specifics.
Cornell (ED / RD)	Arts & Sciences accepts a musical recording as its only supplemental material — submit with the Nov 1 / Jan 2 application per A&S instructions.
No music at admission	UChicago (2-min video is general, not musical), UPenn, UC Berkeley, UIUC, UW — ensembles audition <i>after</i> enrollment.

One recording session can feed almost everything. A single well-produced October session covering ① a movement of solo Bach, ② the first movement (or exposition) of a Romantic-era concerto, and ③ a short contrasting piece satisfies Stanford, Princeton, MIT, Yale, and Cornell outright and supplies both required prescreens (NEC needs a *second* contrasting Bach movement; CMU needs the memorized étude/caprice — the only item on no other list). Record in one block, then trim per school. The live-audition-only additions (NEC's piano sonata/Mozart + meaningful piece) can be prepared over winter break for February.

Three planning notes. ① **Only one early card can be played** among Harvard REA, Yale SCEA, Princeton SCEA, Stanford REA, UPenn ED, Cornell ED, and UChicago ED I — the restrictive/binding programs exclude each other (MIT EA is non-restrictive but is barred *by the other schools'* REA/SCEA rules; UIUC EA, UW, and the UCs are public/non-binding and combine freely with any of them). ② An **SAT EBRW retake** aimed at 750+ must land by the October sitting for REA/SCEA schools — August or September is safer. ③ **Dec 1 is the quiet killer:** the NEC prescreen video and CMU violin prescreen both come due four weeks after the Nov 1 wave — the recording should exist by October, not be scheduled for Thanksgiving.

Repertoire verified Aug 15, 2026 against NEC's violin audition page, CMU's violin requirements page, Stanford Music's recorded-arts-portfolio page, Princeton's optional-arts-supplement page, MIT's creative-portfolios page, and Yale's supplementary-materials page. NEC dual-degree candidates are auditioned to a higher standard than regular B.M. applicants; the published B.M. repertoire is the base requirement. Dates consolidated from the twelve program dossiers (ai-kitchen-inc/university-admission-research · brochures/), each researched against official admissions, program, and aid pages on August 15, 2026. Where a school had not yet posted its 2026–27 calendar, the current published cycle's dates are shown — re-verify each on the official page when applications open. UChicago's Nov 2 early deadline reflects its published page (Nov 1, 2026 is a Sunday); confirm in-cycle. Decision months marked "–" are the school's typical release window, not a guaranteed date.